DO YOU KNOW?

I. The number of cases registered for child abuse raised from 8,904 in the year 2014 to 14,913 in the year 2015, under the POSCO Act. Sexual offences and kidnapping account for 81% of the crimes against minors

II. Preventive measures designed to ward off strangers (installing CCTV cameras and providing self-defence training) will be ineffective, as children do not know how to ward off unwanted sexual offences from their known relatives, acquaintances or workplace seniors, who they trust.

III. POSCO: State wise cases - Uttar Pradesh led the highest number of child abuse cases (3,078) followed by Madhya Pradesh (1,687 cases), Tamil Nadu (1,544 cases), Karnataka (1,480 cases) and Gujarat (1,416 cases).

Along with workplace cases, here are other findings of rapists being known to children: 94.8% of rape cases saw children being raped by someone they knew, not strangers. These acquaintances include neighbors (3,149 cases) who were the biggest abusers (35.8%). 10% of cases saw children being raped by their own direct family members and relatives.

- Touching or rubbing oneself sexually around another person
- Standing close or brushing up against another person

6.5 Schemes and Programmes on Child Protection

The Government has initiated various Schemes to address the problems. Some of the Schemes are outlined as follows:

- **Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS)** is a Centrally Sponsored Scheme which provides a package of six services to children below 6 years and pregnant and lactating mothers.
- **Integrated Child Protection Scheme (ICPS)** was introduced in 2009-10 with the aim to the improve the well being of children in difficult circumstances, as well as the reduction of vulnerabilities to situations that lead to abuse, neglect, exploitation, abandonment and separation of children from their families.
- **Scheme for Welfare of Working Children** in Need of Care and Protection provides opportunities including non-formal education, vocational training, etc. to working children to facilitate their entry / re-entry into mainstream education.
- **Rajiv Gandhi Scheme for Empowerment of Adolescent Girls (RGSEAG)-SABLA** aims at an all-round development of adolescent girls (AGs) of 11-18 years by making them self reliant by facilitating access to learning, health and nutrition through various interventions such as health, education, vocational training etc. Such empowerment also addresses the issue of Child Marriage.
- **Indira Gandhi Matritva Sahyog Yojana (IGMSY)** is a Conditional Cash Transfer Scheme for pregnant and lactating women which was introduced in October, 2010 for improved health and nutrition to pregnant and nursing mothers.
- **Trafficking: "Ujjawala"** – is a Comprehensive Scheme for Prevention of Trafficking and Rescue, Rehabilitation, Re-integration and Repatriation of Victims of Trafficking for Commercial Sexual Exploitation.

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